WELCOME TO
LAKEWOOD VILLAGE
SUNNYVALE
Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

THE L.V.N.A.

VILLAGER

Circulation 1700

February 1996

Tagalog Corner

Angie Dela Cruz

Ang "Sunnyvale Community Services" ay nangangailangan ng inyong tulong! Makakatulong kayo sa mga punong guro, mga guro ng paaralan, pulisya, ospital sa ating siyudad na Sunnyvale. Kung kayo ay interesado at mahusay kayong magsalin ng English sa Tagalog, maari kayong tumawag sa tagapamahala ng "Sunnyvale Volunteer Language Bank" na si **Chris Skok**. Ang telepono niya ay **738-4298**.

Editors Note: If I've slaughtered the above message because of misspellings or inappropriate punctuation, I apologize. Please forgive my ignorance of the language. Now, where are those Spanish, Vietnamese, Chinese, Laotian, and Burmese articles? ☺



Native Tongues

Geoff Carter

You can have your special message in your native tongue here. Just provide me with either a printed copy with the correct spelling and punctuation or a computer disk with the document on it. That's it! Simple and easy. I cant promise you'll be in every edition, but you will have your fair share of space.

Next L.V.N.A. Meeting

All residents of Lakewood Village are encouraged and invited to attend these meetings. You will meet your neighbors, learn about upcoming events of special interest to our community, have a chance to voice your concerns and opinions; and help work towards a better neighborhood. Children are welcome.

Date	Wednesday, February 21st, 1996
Time:	7:00 PM
Location:	Lakewood Park Building at Lakechime and Silverlake.
Agenda:	1. Volunteer Appreciation Dinner 2. Awards Ceremony & Dance

Village Children Recognized

Taken from the *Lakewood Lion*, Lakewood Elementary School Newsletter

The following students were recognized as Student of the Month for November: Nickie Telly, Elliot Harrell, Vaibhav Narayanam, Jeremy Ancheta, Jessica Emerson, Ricky Sena, Veronica Hernandez, Stefan Falcon, Precious Ethyl Presto, Salvador Rangel, April DeJesus, Stephanie Phan, Elisa Wikey, Jerica Palacio, Marvin Rosario, Robert Twidwell, Diane Tambalo, Joseph Garcia, Milana Jordan, Kevin La, Chris Ingalls, Elaine Mallari, Phuong Vuong, Steven Moore, Rex Sagayaga, Noel Galano, Ruben Rodrigues, Benny Gonzales, Heather Cox, and Aileen Roselo. If you see any of these kids, let them know you appreciate their efforts.

And, for the month of December, here is the list of those who made the Student of the Month list: Kevin Ly, Jennifer Phan, Michael Arimas, Maricris Rosario, Monique Nguyen, Amy Wanninger, Susan Ma, Bernadette Pascual, MaryRose Javier, Nomar Tanjoco, Caroline Crawford, Robert Hua, Alex Torres, Ronna Navarro, Carla Aguilar, Debbie Rodriguez, Mark Refuerzo, Tony Diec, Randy Caguiat, Cheryl Garcia, Caroline Bui, Teresa Lwee, Jacob Flores, Amie Mariano, Christina Pina, Angelina Hermosillo, Joanna Atayde, Leelybeel Solo, Willy Lopez, and Vincent Piazza. Excellent effort boys and girls. If you know these children, be sure to let them know how proud the people of Lakewood Village are to have them living in our midst.

Officers of the L.V.N.A.

President	Craig Crawford	736-7371
1st Vice President	Violette Pavatea	749-9758
2nd Vice President	Phyllis Fowler	747-1454
Secretary	Ana Maria Ortega	745-6028
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Newsletter Editor	Geoff Carter	733-0502
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Getting to Know You

Pat Vorreiter

Councilmember, Seat 6

An on-going series of articles by and about various city officials. Information in this article was provided by the subject with editing done by the L.V.N.A. Villager staff to fit within the space constraints.

Pat Vorreiter may be a newly-elected Councilmember, but she is not new to Sunnyvale. She and her husband have been residents of our community for 28 years. Her three children have grown up here and have been involved in many community youth activities.

Pat returned to school when her children were in elementary school and earned a Juris Doctor degree from Santa Clara University School of Law in 1980. She currently has a law office in Sunnyvale practicing family law, estate planning, and probate.

Pat hopes to maintain Sunnyvale as a safe, secure, and healthy community where the City government provides the opportunities for its citizens to develop a sense of community. She wants to hear your ideas for your neighborhood and for our community at large so that we can continue to live in a community of which we can be proud. She believes that a "social connection" to the community is fundamental to residents taking pride and ownership in their community.

Maintaining our service level with the increased demands on our financial resources will be a challenge during the coming years. We have become accustomed to high community standards and do not want our community to compromise those services.

Pat wants to represent our community voice in the future planning of the use of the Moffett Field air facility. If its role in our regional economy changes, we want Sunnyvale to be a major player in the planning.

Since being elected, Pat has been appointed to many important committees. She hopes to continue Sunnyvale's leadership and visibility at the state and regional level.

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Hey Man, Got .50 for a Burrito? Part II

Craig Crawford

I have more info to share about this controversial issue. At our last L.V.N.A. meeting the room was packed with people upset. No they weren't upset with me for being frank and telling it like it is. They were upset with the problem of bum's being allowed to thrive in our neighborhood.

I had a meeting with Dick's Market manager "Stan", and several of the staff that deal with the bum's on a daily basis. The meeting started out with five of them telling me that we have it so good here in Lakewood Village. They have a store in East Santa Clara that has murders across the street and all sorts of horror stories about how it could be a lot worse here.

My point was that we just wanted to stop this problem in our neighborhood before it got to be any bigger. They just didn't get where I was coming from. It was also said by one of the staff "what did we expect, this is the bad side of Sunnyvale." After that was said things started to heat up with your loyal President rattling off several expletives in rapid order.

Continued on page 3

Some of us learn from others mistakes. The rest of us are the other people.

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Mr. Rogers' Neighborhood?

Mar Junge

One of the best things about Lakewood Village is the stability of the neighborhood. I've lived here almost twenty years and most of my neighbors have lived here even longer. We have many friends in The Village who bought the house they grew up in and are now raising their own children here. How lucky we are to live in a close-knit neighborhood that is now home to its third generation of residents.

Another good example of neighborhood stability is Fun Learning Preschool. The school's director, Lupita Montoya, has lived in Lakewood Village all her life. She began teaching at the preschool shortly after it opened in 1983. After teaching there for 11 years, Lupita saved up enough money to buy the school and has been its director since 1992. Her younger sister, Carla, now a sophomore at Fremont High School, was one of the first to graduate from Fun Learning and is also a Lakewood resident.

"I still live around the corner from my preschool, and many of my students are also my neighbors. Quite a few of our graduates still live in the neighborhood too, so we often have older children visiting us in the afternoons, just to say hello," Lupita said. "Growing up and going to school in the same neighborhood gives kids a sense of security. They're more eager to learn and aren't afraid to try new activities."

One activity that the preschoolers love is visiting Lakewood Elementary School to watch music shows, plays, and other assemblies. In addition, the preschoolers often visit Lakewood's classrooms to meet their future teachers.

The stability of the preschool and its staff not only benefits the children, but also helps build community spirit as well. At the Christmas parade and park dedication in December, I saw a lot of children from Fun Learning Preschool, as well as from Lakewood Elementary School, who were playing together and having fun. This was the best community event I've attended. As Mr. Rogers would say, "It was a wonderful day in the neighborhood." My thanks to all who worked so hard to make it happen.. ☙

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Burrito's (continued from page 2)

After things settled down the conversation began to get at the heart of the problem.

1. We the residents of Lakewood care about the quality of life that we raise our children in.
2. We are protective of our neighborhood and this includes Dick's Market.
3. Dick's Market and the residents have a strong financial interest in Lakewood.
4. We both want to rid the plaza of the harassment of panhandling and the hanging out of the bum's.

We ended our meeting with Stan and the L.V.N.A. pledging to work on this problem together. Public Safety will be called and a meeting will be arranged to see what legal means are available to clean up this problem before it turns into East Santa Clara.

Special note: have you noticed that Dick's Market has looked cleaner and has better service lately? I think this is the result of a great manager and a staff that cares about Lakewood Village and the surrounding neighborhoods. Thank you.. ☙

Chains do not hold a marriage together; it is hundreds of tiny threads. *Simone Signoret*

Newsletter Taken to Task

Linda Cheung

When my husband and I bought our first house in Lakewood four years ago, we were energized by L.V.N.A.'s leadership, and we were excited to be living among so many good people with a shared vision for the community.

At the time, there was no clear separation between the neighbors and the L.V.N.A. Any time the L.V.N.A. took a stand politically, it was over issues that we all considered important. As I recall, the primary goals of the L.V.N.A. were to improve the appearance of Lakewood Village and the image we present to the rest of Sunnyvale. In particular, we were concerned about giving young residents some activities to keep them busy and help them take pride in their neighborhood.

Attendance at monthly meetings was phenomenal, as was positive response to the monthly newsletter. Back then, the *Villager* was a humble, single-sheet publication. A typical issue might include a photo of a recent neighborhood event, one positive and informative letter from the president, a message for local teens, announcements of upcoming events, and some brief reminders about volunteer opportunities and the appearance of our homes and streets. *Humble, brief, positive.*

In sharp contrast, the newsletters which I have been receiving from the L.V.N.A. and other ad hoc neighborhood groups for the last year or more make me angry, sometimes confused, sad, and embarrassed to be living here.

If I had to characterize these publications, I would call them petty, arrogant, and mean-spirited. I read articles, and what I hear is "Our neighborhood stinks because of irresponsible citizens like you." and "If you're not with us, you're against us." Ads for friendly neighborhood businesses seem strangely out of place, surrounded by such vicious attacks against past presidents, elected officials, and our own neighbors.

I'm not against anyone; I want to see our neighborhood grow stronger and more unified. I think the newsletter should be only half as long as it is. I would rather see fewer items, and have those items be briefer and occasionally written by or adopted from a source other than the president or newsletter editor.

I think the newsletter should bring neighbors together and help us share information. What do you think?

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A Rebuttal

Geoff Carter

Dear Friends and Neighbors. It would appear that we have finally stirred you up to the point of making your voices heard again. It has never been the intent of either the editor or the Leadership of the L.V.N.A. to make this newsletter exclusively the Geoff and Craig show. Believe it or not, we have always been open to inputs from anybody and everybody in the neighborhood. Every article ever submitted has been run as is (except editing to fit in the available space). You don't like what I have to say? Give me something to put in its stead. The six page format was adopted to accommodate ads which support the printing of the newsletter and activities sponsored by the L.V.N.A. It's the only money coming in.

Mrs. Cheung would have us sugar-coat the news or keep quiet We kinda figured, being adults, you want to hear the news. To quote a retired editor of a major daily newspaper, "If you wanna get read, include some controversy to make 'em think and some humor to make 'em laugh." The main thrust of the articles presented here during the past year do reflect the original goals as recalled by Mrs. Cheung. If the writings of either the President of L.V.N.A. or this newsletter editor has given you motivation to be heard and get involved, then I'd count that as a success. We've tried to be even-handed in our references to ALL past presidencies of the L.V.N.A. But it seems even the mere mention of a favored subject is falsely attributed to being some sort of "bashing."

You want the neighborhood to grow stronger and more unified? So do I. So do your neighbors. Put your money where your mouth is and become involved, once again, in the best neighborhood organization in Santa Clara valley.

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Another Point of View

Gene Goldsmith

I just finished reading the January issue of the L.V.N.A. newsletter. It was very disheartening to read the mean spirited articles while on the opposite page was an article about helping our neighbors. Seems like a contradiction here. These so-called "bums" are also our neighbors and need help. Take time to know these people and you learn that most of them grew up here, went to school here, and have lived in this neighborhood all their lives. It should not be a crime to be homeless and they should not be hounded out of the only place they've ever known and felt safe in. They are honest, decent folks who wouldn't think of stealing your car, burglarizing your home, mugging you in the park, or molesting your children. While it may look like they're partying in the park, they are actually serving a valuable function. Their presence makes the park safer by acting as unpaid eyes and ears to prevent graffiti, gang activity, and vandalism. They have skills and are willing to work (I know one of them helped build the baseball bleachers) so if you have some odd jobs they could do, you know where to find them, and it's better than hiring a stranger. They are probably better neighbors than the homeowners who dump their trash on Dick's property.

It's true the "arm amputee" has developed some mental problems since loosing his arm in a motorcycle accident. Although he talks to himself and the "walls" he seems harmless and is taking care of himself as best he can. The "glassy eyed female bum" also has a history of mental problems but is currently taking medication to help herself. People with harmless mental problems have very few options to help ever since Gov. Reagan closed the mental facilities and put them on the street.

So, call off your police. They have better things to do. Let's find ways to show that Lakewood Village really is a caring and sharing place. If you have some extra food, used clothing, etc., drop it off on your way to the store. They need our help but are too proud to ask..

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From the desk of the President

Craig Crawford, President L.V.N.A.

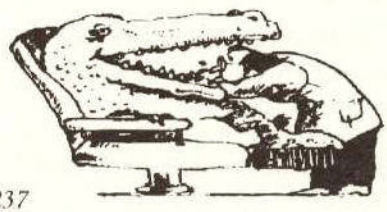
The volunteer appreciation night will be Feb 21 at the Lakewood Park building. The dinner for the volunteers will be 7:00 to 7:30. The award ceremony and dancing will be after dinner. At this time the entire membership can join in the celebration and good times provided. Ted, the music provider at the picnic will be with us again. If you haven't heard him and his son play you are missing out. I f you have volunteered time this year in the L.V.N.A. and have not received an invitation call me and I will get you one.

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Homeless and Bums, the Difference

Craig Crawford

It seems to me that many of you people out there are so concerned with being politically correct that you are out of touch with reality. You have been brain washed by the liberal media into believing that if you don't have a place to live you are automatically homeless. This could not be farther from the truth. When was the last time you have seen a homeless mother or father with children in tow begging for money? You haven't. Our society has in place safety nets to catch the people who are down on their luck and want to help themselves. Churches, private shelters and governmental agencies all have places to go to get you on your feet again. I am the first to advocate keeping these safety nets strong and in place.

The people that we see at the corner of Lawrence and El Camino and in our own neighborhood are, by and large, bums. I have seen the same faces for years with the same tired signs saying "homeless." These people are cowards and a disgrace hiding behind the banner of homeless. They are there because they have drug and alcohol problems. Problems that they can control. We all control our destiny and they are there because they want to be, not because they are homeless. It's an excuse not to take responsibility for your actions. A shelter won't take them because they require sobriety. They have burned the bridges with friends and relatives who might have provided help. They are too lazy to get a job. Why should they? The government pays them to be the way they are.

They have a monthly cycle they live by. On the 1st of the month a check is given to them because of a disability called drug or alcohol abuse. Can you believe it, the government gives them a check to continue their habit? They take this money and blow it within a few days feeding their habits. The rest of the month they beg for money to continue the cycle. Do you really think this money that you give is being used in the same spirit in which it's given? You can bet that as soon as the hand is full the liquor store or a drug dealer will get a little richer. When the 1st rolls around again the cycle repeats itself.

We as a people take care of our own. The ones that truly need help get help. But some on the edge prey on the good natured help of misguided people who are hurting the same people that they are trying to help.

Working on television is like being shot out of a cannon. BANG — there you are in somebody's living room.
Tullulah Bankhead



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Newsletter Contributions

Geoff Carter, Editor

If you have a message or concern that would be of interest to our neighbors, please submit your article(s) for the March newsletter no later than Friday, March 1st. All submissions will be considered and printed as space allows. For further information, contact Geoff Carter at 733-0502.

Articles of general interest to the neighborhood are wanted. They will be printed, space providing, with editing only for obvious spelling errors, grammar, (expletives cheerfully deleted) and to fit within the available space. The facts are the responsibility of the author.

Thanks to those who contributed to this month's newsletter: Linda Cheung, Angie Dela Cruz, Mar Junge, Gene Goldsmith, Pat Vorrieter, the *Lakewood Lion*, and our President, Craig Crawford.

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